IMSERV®

Discovery round 2

Astral customer discovery
Activity 4 of 7 · Draft for review · October 2026

Activity 4
Discovery round 2, targeted



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ACTIVITY 4 OF 7

Discovery round 2, targeted

Fill the gaps round 1 found and test our early interpretations.

PROVISIONAL DURATION

2 to 3 weeks, including analysis

DEPENDS ON

Gap recruitment

OUTPUT

Wider coverage, tested interpretations, and provisional archetypes.

OBJECTIVES IT SERVES

- 1. **Understand** how customers do their energy-data work today, from trigger to finished outcome, including spreadsheets, email, and other tools.
- 2. **Identify** recurring behavioural patterns that need different design priorities or trade-offs.
- 3. **Understand** what people check before they trust and share a figure or a report.
- 4. **Identify** who does, approves, and receives the work, and where handoffs and waiting happen.
- 5. **Determine** where problems come from the service, process, or data rather than the interface.

THE SEVEN ACTIVITIES

1	Agree scope and decisions
2	Set up recruitment
3	Discovery round 1
4	**Discovery round 2, targeted**
5	Survey
6	Integrate and follow up
7	Test design implications

PRIMARY RESEARCH QUESTION

How do IMSERV customers do their energy-data work today, and which differences in that work should change how Astral is designed and prioritised?

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What happens

What happens

As round 1. 6 to 8 participants recruited into the gaps.

1

Recruit into the gaps

6 to 8 participants recruited into the gaps round 1 found.

2

Test early interpretations

Fill the gaps round 1 found and test our early interpretations.

3

Bring in BA questions

The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2.

4

Form provisional archetypes

Archetypes come from recurring patterns. They are not job titles with a new label.

Sample this round

Two rounds of 6 to 8 is a starting proposal, not a promise of coverage. Plan rounds, not a total.

Participants recruited into the gaps

6–8

Format as round 1
60 minutes, remote

When to keep recruiting

A rare, high-impact need is not dropped because it appeared once.

CONTEXTS

Important contexts are still unexplored.

DIFFERENCES

New behavioural differences keep appearing.

CONTRADICTIONS

Consequential contradictions are unresolved.

On sample size

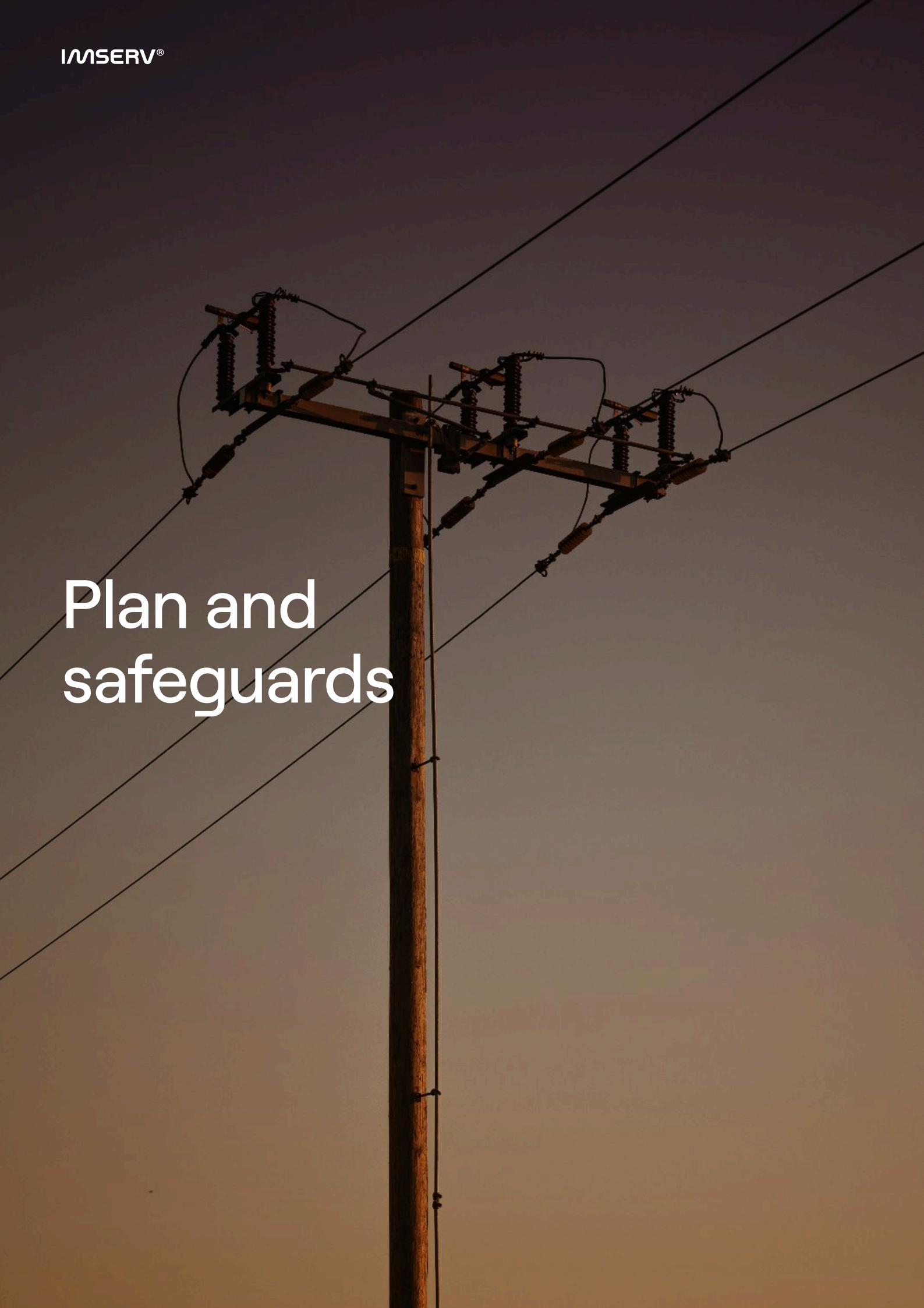
GOV.UK suggests about 4 to 8 participants per qualitative round, with more rounds as needed.

A systematic review found saturation often within 9 to 17 interviews, in fairly similar groups with narrow aims (Hennink and Kaiser, 2022).

What that does not show

It does **not** show 12 to 16 interviews are enough for IMSERV's varied, multi-role audience. Two rounds of 6 to 8 is a starting proposal, not a promise of coverage.

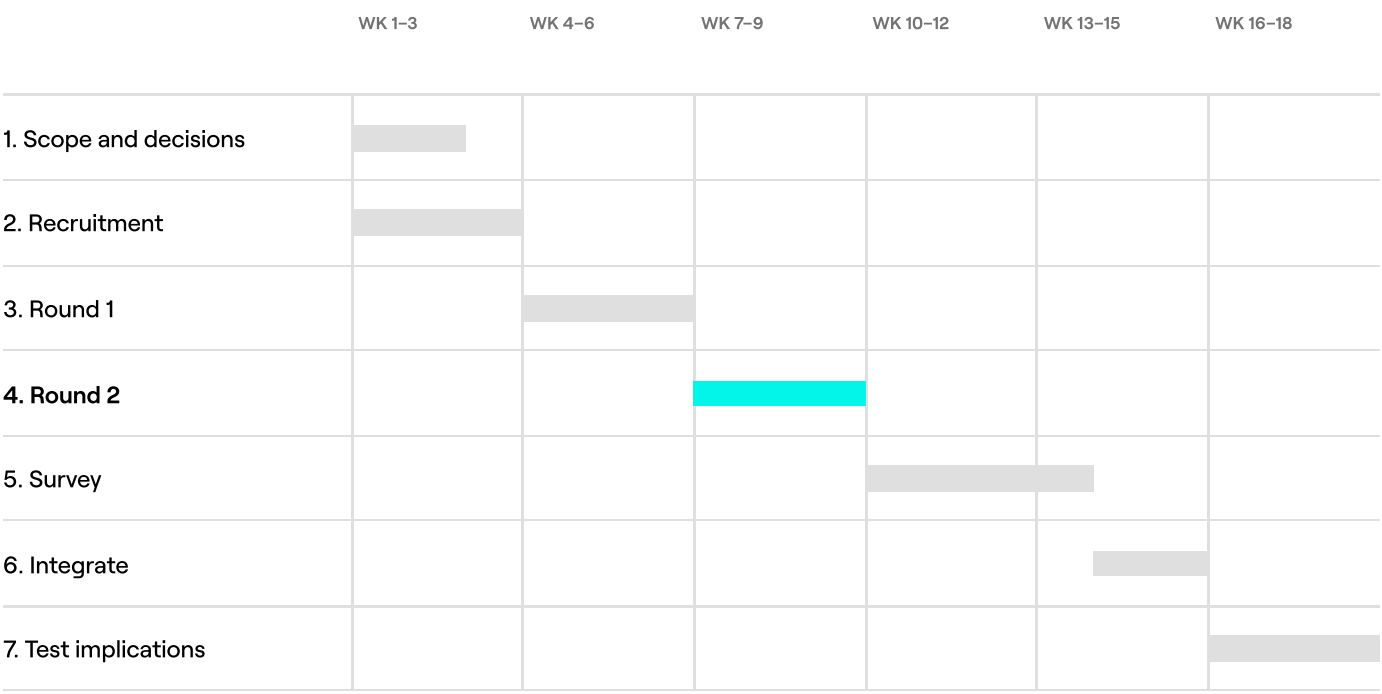
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Plan and safeguards

Where it sits

Estimates to agree, not commitments. Bars show the upper estimate for each stage. With overlap, roughly 12 to 18 weeks from agreement to tested implications.



Stage	Provisional duration	Depends on
4. Discovery round 2, targeted	2 to 3 weeks, including analysis	Gap recruitment

Objective-to-evidence

How this activity answers the objectives. Measures serve an objective. They are not collected for their own sake.

Objective	Research question	Evidence	Measure
1. Understand	What triggers the work, and what does finished look like?	Episode accounts, artefacts	Journey stages covered per scenario
2. Identify	Which patterns recur across organisations, roles, and scales?	Coded episodes across participants and organisations	Patterns observed in n of N participants and organisations
3. Understand	What do people check before relying on a figure?	Described and shown checks. Reported frequency	Reported frequency among respondents
4. Identify	Who contributes, approves, or acts?	Handoffs, correspondence	Handoffs per journey. Waiting points
5. Determine	Where does it slow down, and why?	Breakdowns traced to cause	Problems classed interface, process, or data

Neutral draft. No consent wording is sent until it is approved. Legal review before it reaches a participant.

Consent, privacy and data

Agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session.

Every session

- Informed consent for every participant before the session
- Recording, transcription, storage, retention, and any AI processing agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session
- Approved storage with restricted access. Raw recordings and transcripts stay restricted
- Customer documents shown in walkthroughs are redacted or not kept, as agreed
- Participants are P01, P02 in analysis. Removing names alone may not anonymise a distinctive business account
- Quotes in shared outputs only with consent for anonymised quotation
- No consent wording is sent until it is approved. The current wording is a neutral draft

How AI is used

Copilot can help organise approved material, suggest candidate patterns, and keep evidence links up to date. Only within what the privacy owner approves.

It will **not** invent quotes, build archetypes from job titles, or treat simulated customers as evidence.

Risks and limits

What could weaken the evidence, and what we do about it.

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
Twelve interviews are treated as enough	A multi-role audience is under-covered	Plan rounds, not a total. Keep recruiting while important gaps remain
Participants come from one or two organisations	Shared local process looks like a pattern	Track organisation coverage. Recruit across several
Archetypes are expected before evidence exists	A persona deck without support	Agree upfront that archetypes emerge from rounds 1 and 2

Wider coverage, tested interpretations, and provisional archetypes.

Output

Early findings reach the BA team from round 1, not only at the end.

Hands over to

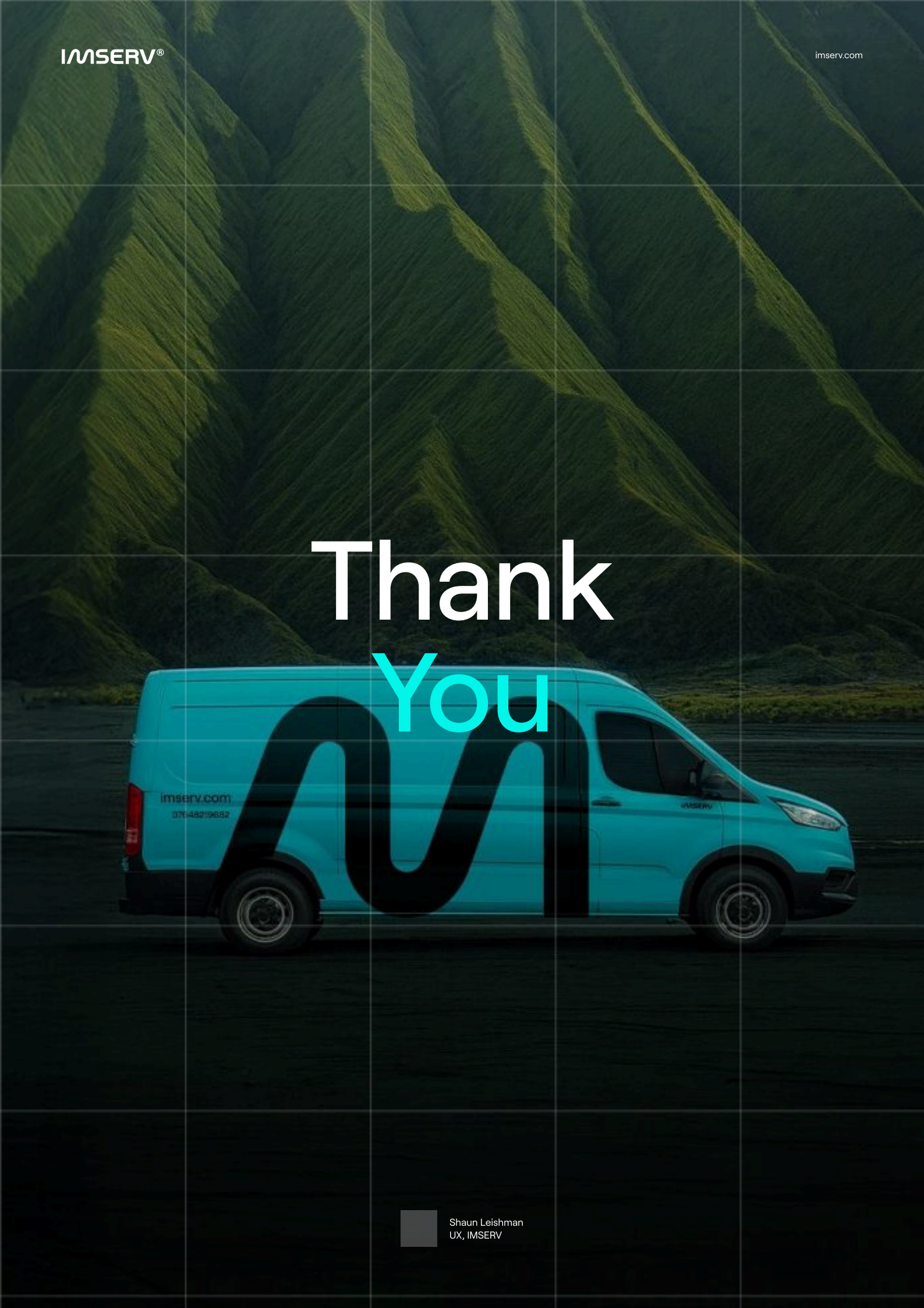
Activity 5. Survey.

Gauge how often the patterns from discovery happen across a wider group of respondents.

Working alongside the BA team

- Round 1 findings are shared with the BA team as they emerge, marked provisional
- Stories link back to the need and evidence behind them
- The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2

Thank You



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